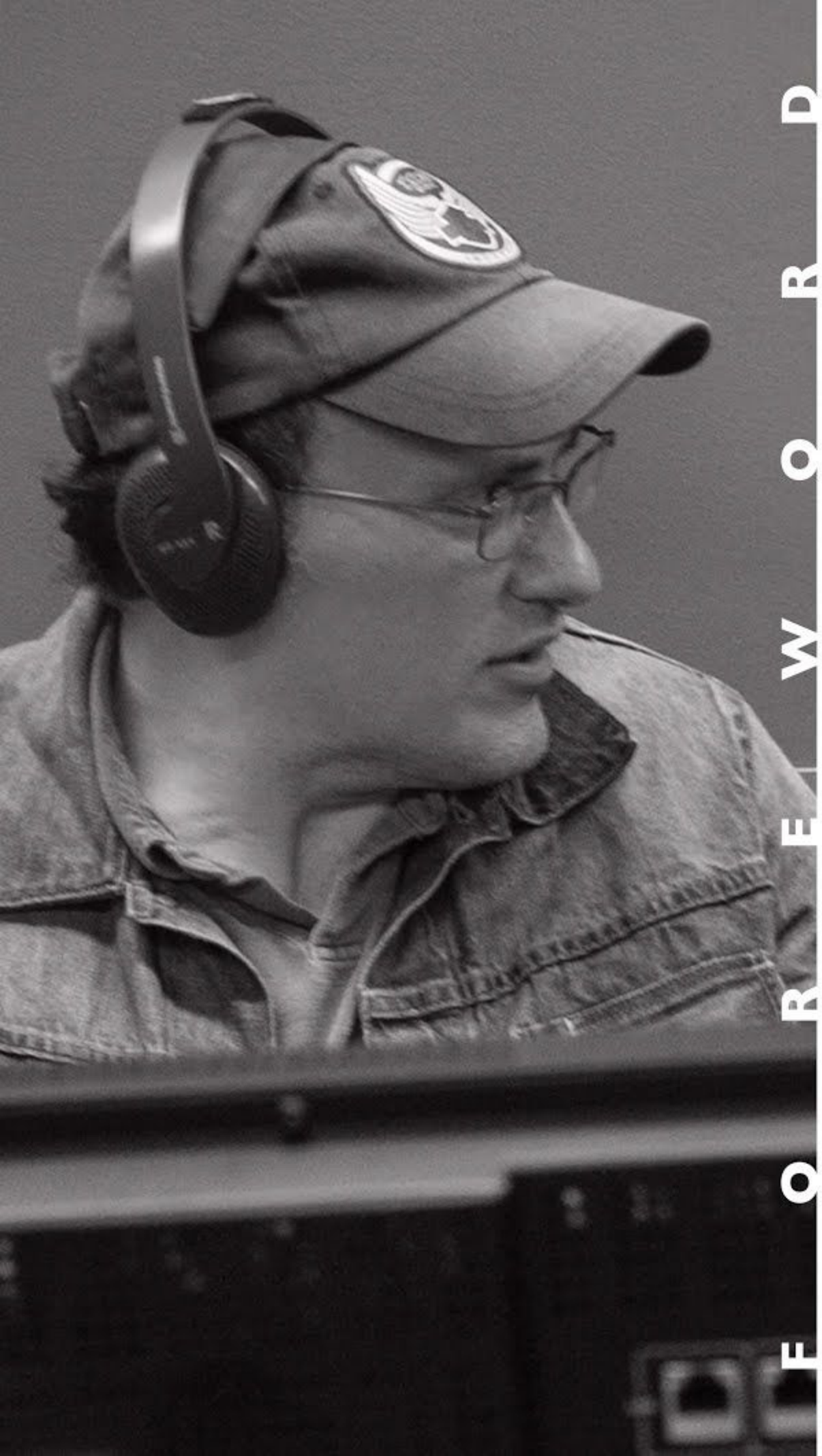


store nestled between a 7-Eleven and a Mr. Hero in the eastern suburbs of Cleveland. And even though De Palma is often thought of as a master of tension, by Webster's definition, he's also quite possibly one of the best action directors of the 20th century. His characters' aims are specific and rootable (even though they tragically don't often achieve them). And his true gift as a filmmaker, like Friedkin, is the ability to create protracted sequences where the character's aim is constantly in danger of being thwarted. Long sequences filled with inventive, detailed, harrowing, and thoughtful mini-narratives. The climax in *Blow Out*. The stairwell scene in *The Untouchables*. The white-vault scene in *Mission: Impossible*.

It's from Friedkin and De Palma that we drew a lot of our inspiration for *Captain America: The Winter Soldier*. We tried to give the characters clear aims–most often survival or escape, and then attempted to complicate those aims through narrative. Nick Fury's hubris makes him vulnerable. Steve Rogers' disenfranchisement keeps him off balance. We then tried to follow Friedkin and De Palma's example by creating long sequences filled with mini-narratives where the characters' aims are constantly in danger of being thwarted. The sequence where Fury is ambushed in his car, and then pursued as he attempts to escape, ultimately undone by the Winter Soldier. The sequence where Cap is attacked in the elevator. Or where Winter Soldier assaults Cap, Natasha, and Sam on the freeway, and Steve is forced to battle him for the first time to save Natasha's life.

The effort to keep these long sequences detailed and inventive was both arduous and fulfilling. And required an incredible amount of collaboration. As did every detail of the film.

From the writers, Christopher Markus and Steven McFeeley, who spent more than two years expertly fashioning the screenplay.

To our Producer, the brilliant auteur of the MCU, Kevin Feige.

To our Executive Producers, Lou D'Esposito and Victoria Alonso, the best in the business at what they do–and, more importantly, two of the best people we know.

To our Co-Producer Nate Moore, who functioned as the third Russo Brother on this film, and whose exceptional taste and creativity is expressed in the movie as much as ours.

To our Cinematographer Trent Oplach, whose visceral and dynamic camera work and trenchant lighting brought the script to life.